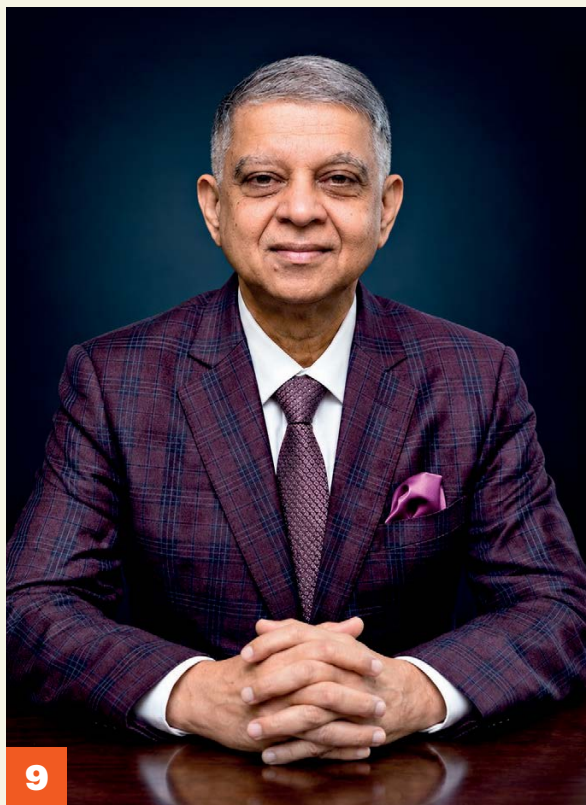




DR. AJIT GUPTA
CHAIRMAN, PARK MEDI
WORLD LTD.

(FY26 REVENUE: ₹1,679 CR)

Dr. Ajit Gupta brings together more than four decades of clinical experience with over two decades of hospital leadership. A graduate of the University College of Medical Sciences, Delhi, he began his medical career at Safdarjung Hospital before going on to establish Park Hospital and Sunil Nursing Home. Those two institutions formed the foundation on which Park Hospitals was subsequently built. Dr. Gupta's career trajectory, from public hospital training to founding independent facilities and eventually building a broader hospital group, reflects a pattern common among India's private healthcare pioneers, in which deep clinical grounding preceded and informed later institution-building and network expansion.

THE NEW GUARD

As India's first corporate hospital chains took root, a new generation of doctors embraced entrepreneurship in its own way. Some built focused hospital chains around a single specialty. Others created institutions centred on advanced tertiary care or diagnostic excellence. They built different kinds of healthcare businesses, but were driven by the same instinct as those who came before them: to solve a problem they believed the healthcare system had overlooked.

Alongside these multi-speciality builders, a separate set of doctors chose to go deep into a single field rather than run general hospitals.

Dr. Ramesh Kancharla, Chairman and MD of Rainbow Children's Medicare Ltd, spent close to eight years working at children's hospitals in the UK before returning to India convinced that paediatric care could not simply be treated as a smaller version of adult medicine. It needed dedicated infrastructure, specialised doctors and hospitals designed around newborns, infants and children. That conviction led him to establish Rainbow Children's Hospital in Hyderabad in 2000 with just 50 beds. Rain-

bow expanded over the next two decades by replicating that model across southern India before turning to the North.

The network today runs 24 hospitals and six clinics across nine cities, with a combined bed capacity of over 2,500, built around a hub-and-spoke model of large tertiary centres supported by smaller satellite units. In FY26, the company reported a revenue of ₹1,703 crore, up 12%, and it now plans to add more than 2,500 beds over the next five years, taking the network toward roughly 5,000 beds. Partnerships with global investors, including the UK's British International Investment, helped fund that expansion, and the company went public in 2022.

Dr. Aashish Chaudhry, Managing Director of Aakash Healthcare, represents a younger generation of doctor-preneurs who entered healthcare after corporate hospitals had become an established industry. Rather than building a sprawling hospital network from the outset, he focused on creating a tertiary-care institution in Delhi centred on advanced clinical care, medical technology and patient experience. He founded Aakash Healthcare with the belief that clinical excellence, technology, af-